

HiSET Teacher's Guide: Course Profile

Course Overview

Course Title: Teaching the HiSET: A Comprehensive Guide for Educators

Evidence of product: [Current Progress Displayed here](#)

Format: Interactive E-Learning Module (Articulate Rise)

Target Audience: Adult Education Instructors, Former K-12 Educators, GED/HiSET Program Coordinators, Adult Literacy Volunteers

Estimated Duration: 2-3 hours total (6 lessons, approximately 30 minutes each)

Course Purpose

This course provides educators with essential knowledge and strategies for effectively preparing adult learners for the High School Equivalency Test (HiSET). The course emphasizes understanding key differences between HiSET and GED, addressing common challenges faced by adult learners, and implementing evidence-based instructional strategies specific to HiSET preparation.

Learner Analysis

Primary Audience:

- **Experience Level:** Licensed educators with teaching experience but new to high school equivalency instruction
- **Prior Knowledge:** Strong content knowledge in their licensed areas but limited familiarity with HiSET/high school equivalency programs
- **Technical Skills:** Basic computer literacy required
- **Motivation:** Professional development, expanding teaching capabilities, desire to support adult learners
- **Challenges:** Adapting pedagogical approaches from traditional K-12 to adult high school equivalency contexts
- **Learning Environment:** Self-paced online learning

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, learners will be able to:

1. Differentiate between HiSET and GED exam structures, formats, and requirements
2. Apply appropriate instructional strategies for each HiSET content area
3. Address unique challenges faced by adult learners in HiSET preparation
4. Implement effective assessment and practice test strategies
5. Locate and customize HiSET-specific teaching materials
6. Support students in post-HiSET educational and career planning

Course Structure

Lesson 1: Understanding the HiSET Exam

- HiSET vs. GED: Key Differences
- HiSET Scoring and College Readiness
- HiSET Test Structure and Content

Lesson 2: Challenges of Teaching HiSET Students

- Understanding Nontraditional Student Needs
- Addressing Barriers to Learning
- Building Trust and Motivation

Lesson 3: Building Confidence in Students and Teachers

- Creating a Positive Learning Environment
- Strategies for Student Confidence Building
- Teacher Confidence in HiSET Instruction

Lesson 4: Using Practice Tests Effectively

- Selecting Appropriate Practice Tests
- Analyzing Practice Test Results
- Incorporating Practice Tests into Lessons

Lesson 5: Locating and Customizing Teaching Materials

- Finding HiSET-Specific Resources
- Adapting Materials for Diverse Learners
- Incorporating Technology into HiSET Prep

Lesson 6: Preparing Students for Success Beyond HiSET

- Exploring Post-HiSET Opportunities
- Teaching Life and Study Skills
- Connecting Students to Support Services

Instructional Approach

The course employs a variety of instructional strategies to engage learners and facilitate knowledge transfer:

- **Interactive Content:** Knowledge checks, scenarios, drag-and-drop activities
- **Authentic Assessment:** Real-world application exercises based on actual teaching scenarios
- **Multimedia Elements:** Videos, infographics, and audio to address different learning preferences
- **Reflection Opportunities:** Guided reflection questions to connect content to personal teaching context
- **Resource Library:** Downloadable templates, checklists, and reference guides

Assessment Strategy

- **Knowledge Checks:** Formative assessments throughout each lesson

- **Application Activities:** Scenario-based exercises requiring application of concepts
- **Course Completion Assessment:** Comprehensive assessment covering all lesson objectives
- **Implementation Plan:** Personal action plan for applying course concepts

Lesson 1 Storyboard

Scene #	Slide #	Screen Content	Text Draft	Design Notes	Interactions	Reviewer Comments
1. INTRO	1.1	Title: Understanding the HiSET Exam Subtitle: A comprehensive guide for educators	Welcome to Lesson 1: Understanding the HiSET Exam. This lesson will provide you with essential knowledge about the exam structure, scoring, and content areas.	- Use HiSET branding colors (orange accent) - Background image: adult education setting	- Start button - Menu navigation	

1. INTRO	1.2	Welcome message: "Congratulations on embarking on this rewarding journey of teaching the HiSET!"	The HiSET program offers a unique opportunity to empower adult learners and help them achieve their high school equivalency credentials.	- Professional, encouraging tone - Clean layout with guidance text	- Next button - Optional audio toggle	
1. INTRO	1.3	Lesson Objectives: - Identify key differences between HiSET and GED - Understand HiSET scoring - Describe test structure and content	By the end of this lesson, you'll be able to clearly explain the HiSET exam to your students and understand how to prepare them effectively.	- Bulleted list with icons - Visual indicators for each objective	- Next button - Printable objectives	
2. BODY	2.1	Section Header: HiSET vs. GED: Key Differences	Let's begin by examining how the HiSET differs from the GED, which will help you explain these differences to prospective students.	- Section transition with visual comparison graphic - Icons for each exam	- Next button - Jump to section option	

2. BODY	2.2	Brief overview explaining both exams serve similar purposes but with different approaches	Both tests serve to certify academic skills equivalent to those of a high school graduate, but they differ in important ways that affect your teaching approach.	- Side-by-side comparison visual - Key points highlighted	- Next button - Info pop-ups on hover	
2. BODY	2.3	Interactive comparison table showing format, cost, resources, and recognition differences	Understanding these differences will help you guide students who may be deciding between the two options or who have transferred from GED preparation.	- Tab-based comparison interface - Color-coded information	- Clickable tabs for categories - Mouseover details	
2. BODY	2.4	Multiple choice question: "Which of the following is a key difference between the HiSET and GED exams?" with options	This knowledge check will reinforce your understanding of the key differences between these exams.	- Question format as shown in Image 2 - Clear radio button selection	- Submit button - Immediate feedback	

2. BODY	2.5	Fill-in-blank activity: "The HiSET exam includes various question types, such as an essay and _____ questions."	The HiSET uses multiple-choice questions along with essays to evaluate student knowledge.	- Text field for answer entry as shown in Image 1 - Hint option available	- Submit button - Feedback based on answer	
3. BODY	3.1	Section Header: HiSET Scoring and College Readiness	Now let's explore how the HiSET is scored and what these scores mean for your students' future opportunities.	- Visual of certificate/diploma - Professional education setting	- Next button - Section bookmark option	
3. BODY	3.2	Explanation of scoring system (0-20 per subtest, passing requirements)	The HiSET uses a scale of 0-20 for each subtest, with both minimum subtest scores and a total score requirement for passing.	- Infographic of scoring ranges - Visual performance level indicators	- Interactive score scale - Tooltips with examples	

3. BODY	3.3	College readiness standards and interpretation guide	Understanding college readiness indicators helps you prepare students not just to pass, but to succeed in further education.	- Visual scale showing thresholds - Example score reports	- Drag-drop matching activity - Completion feedback	
4. BODY	4.1	Section Header: HiSET Test Structure and Content	Let's examine the five subtests that make up the complete HiSET exam.	- Test booklet visual - Icons for each subject area	- Next button - Quick navigation to subjects	
4. BODY	4.2	Overview of five subtests with time allocations and question counts	The five subtests assess different subject areas and skills, each with its own time allocation and format.	- Icons for each subtest - Visual time allocation chart	- Clickable icons for details - Subject area navigation	
4. BODY	4.3	Language Arts-Reading content breakdown	The Reading subtest evaluates comprehension, analysis, and interpretation skills through both fiction and non-fiction passages.	- Pie chart showing content distribution - Sample text passage	- Example question interactions - Teaching tips toggle	

4. BODY	4.4	Language Arts-Writing breakdown with pie chart of components	The Writing subtest includes both multiple-choice questions on conventions and an essay component, as shown in this breakdown.	- Pie chart as shown in Image 4 - Sample essay prompt	- Interactive conventions quiz - Essay evaluation practice	
4. BODY	4.5	Mathematics content breakdown	The Mathematics subtest covers quantitative problem solving with both calculator and non-calculator sections.	- Visual of math topic distribution - Formula reference example	- Sample problem interactions - Teaching strategy tips	
4. BODY	4.6	Science content and skills assessment	The Science subtest focuses on interpretation of scientific information and understanding of scientific concepts.	- Science content visualization - Sample graph interpretation	- Data analysis activity - Teaching points for science	
4. BODY	4.7	Social Studies content areas and skills	The Social Studies subtest assesses understanding of history, geography, economics, and civics through document analysis.	- Content area distribution - Primary source example	- Document analysis practice - Teaching suggestions	

5. CLOSING	5.1	Lesson summary with key points review	Let's review what we've covered about the HiSET exam structure, scoring, and differences from the GED.	- Visual summary with icons - Downloadable reference guide	- Download reference PDF - Review key points option	
5. CLOSING	5.2	Application activity: "Which of the following are key steps to help students succeed?" multiple selection	Apply what you've learned by identifying effective strategies for HiSET instruction.	- Checkbox selection as in Image 2 - Clear instructions	- Submit button - Detailed feedback	
5. CLOSING	5.3	Additional resources and references	These additional resources will support your teaching and provide more in-depth information about specific aspects of the HiSET.	- Resource library interface - Categorized materials	- Clickable resource links - Search functionality	
5. CLOSING	5.4	Preview of Lesson 2 and completion message	Congratulations on completing Lesson 1! Next, we'll explore the unique challenges of teaching HiSET students.	- Preview of next lesson content - Completion certificate	- Continue to Lesson 2 button - Review lesson option	